

Booking Your First Flight

A step-by-step guide to the GDS Trainer terminal simulator

Open `../web/index.html` in a browser to start (or run the `gds-trainer` command-line edition). Everything is typed at the prompt and submitted with **Enter**. Commands aren't case-sensitive, but standard GDS convention is ALL CAPS.

1 Sign in

```
SI
```

Confirms sign-in with a demo agent sine and pseudo city code (PCC). Nothing else works until you're signed in.

2 Search flight availability

Format: `A` + day + month + origin + destination (or `1` in place of `A` — both are real GDS entries)

```
A15AUGDFWORD
```

This requests flights from **DFW** (Dallas/Ft Worth) to **ORD** (Chicago O'Hare) on **August 15**. You'll get back a numbered list of flights, each with airline, flight number, seats open per class (F/J/C/Y/B/M), departure/arrival times.

| A real-world IATA airport code works — the simulator ships with data for ~6,000 airports worldwide.

3 Sell a seat from the list

Format: `0` + line number + class letter + number of seats

```
04Y1
```

Sells **1 seat in Y class from line 4** of the availability display you just pulled up. The simulator confirms the segment and shows your PNR so far (currently just that flight segment). Selling reduces that class's remaining seat count for the rest of the session — sell it down to 0 and the next sell in that class waitlists (status HL) instead of being blocked.

You can also sell a specific flight directly, without pulling up availability first (a "long sell"). Format: `0` + airline + flight number + class + date + origin/destination + status code + party size:

```
0AA100Y15AUGDFWORDNN1
```

4

Add the passenger's name

Format: – + SURNAME + / + GIVEN NAME + TITLE

```
–SMITH/JOHN MR
```

To add **more than one passenger with the same surname** in a single entry, prefix the surname with a count and chain additional given-name/title pairs with /:

```
–2SMITH/JOHN MR/JANE MRS
```

For passengers with different surnames, add a separate – entry for each. The number of named passengers can't exceed the number of seats sold.

To add a **lap infant** traveling with a passenger, append (INF{SURNAME}/{GIVEN}/{DOB}) to that passenger's name entry (DOB is DDMONYY):

```
–SMITH/JOHN MR(INFSMITH/BABY/12JAN26)
```

5

Add passenger travel documents (APIS) (optional)

Format: 3D0CS + document type + / + issuing country + / + number + / + nationality + / + date of birth + / + sex + / + expiry date + – + passenger number

```
3D0CSP/US/123456789/US/12JAN90/M/25DEC30–1
```

This is Advance Passenger Information (APIS) / Secure Flight-style data, tied to a specific passenger by number (–1 above means passenger 1 in the name field). TYPE is P for passport. Dates are DDMONYY, sex is M or F.

For a **lap infant**, append . {INFANT#} after the passenger number — real GDSs don't give infants their own name-field entry, so they're addressed as a decimal off the adult they travel with (1.1 = the 1st infant travelling with passenger 1):

```
3D0CSP/US/123456789/US/12JAN26/M/25DEC30–1.1
```

6

Add special service requests / other service info (optional)

Format: 3{SSRCODE} for a service request (meals, wheelchair, etc.), optionally with a passenger number and free text: 3{SSRCODE}--{PAX#}/{TEXT}. Format: 30SI{AIRLINE}{TEXT} for other-service-info free text to a carrier.

```
3VGML
3WCHR-1/AISLE SEAT PREFERRED
30SIAA VIP PASSENGER
```

Common SSR codes: WCHR/WCHS/WCHC (wheelchair), VGML/BBML/CHML/KSML/MOML/DBML/SPML (meals), BLND/DEAF (accessibility), UMN (unaccompanied minor), PETC (pet in cabin), BSCT (bassinet), XBAG (extra baggage).

A frequent flyer number can optionally carry a loyalty tier:

```
3FQTVAA1234567/GLD
```

Tiers: SLV (Silver), GLD (Gold), PLT (Platinum), DIA (Diamond).

To add an agency-internal note that isn't sent to the airline (distinct from OSI, which is carrier-facing):

```
5VIP CLIENT - HANDLE WITH CARE
```

7

Assign a seat (optional)

Format: 4{N} to display the seat map for itinerary segment N, then 4{N}--{SEAT} to assign one.

```
41
41-14A
```

8

Price the itinerary

Format: WP (once segments and at least one name are on the PNR)

```
WP
```

Prices the itinerary and shows a base fare, itemized taxes, a total, and fare rules (change fee, refundability, advance-purchase requirement) — this is stored on the PNR as a fare quote and is **required before ticketing**. WPNCs prices the lowest fare regardless of seat availability (informational only).

To apply a negotiated/corporate fare code, append it after a slash:

```
WP/ACME01
```

An unrecognized code is rejected with the list of valid codes; a valid one applies its discount to the base fare and is noted on the quote.

9

Add a contact phone number

Format: 9 + phone number + - + location code (A=Agency, H=Home, B=Business, C/M=Cell, F=Fax, HTL=Hotel)

```
9214555-1234-A
```

10 Add "received from" (who the booking request came from)

Format: 6 + text

6JSMITH

11 Add a ticketing arrangement

7TAW/

This means "ticket at will" (no ticketing deadline). There's also 7TAX16AUG/1800 to set a ticketing time limit of Aug 16 at 6:00 PM.

12 Add a form of payment

Format: FPCASH, FPCHECK, or FPCC{TYPE}{CARDNUMBER}/{MMYY} for a credit card (TYPE is VI=Visa, CA=MasterCard, AX=Amex, DC=Diners Club, DS=Discover, JC=JCB).

FPCASH

or

FPCCVI4111111111111111/1225

Just like a real GDS, the PNR can't be saved without a form of payment on file. Card numbers are masked to the last 4 digits once stored.

13 End the transaction (save the booking)

ER

This saves the PNR and gives you a **6-character record locator** — your confirmation code. ER redisplay the saved PNR; ET saves it and clears the screen for a new booking.

14 Issue the ticket (optional)

TKTT

This is the step people often assume ER already did — it doesn't. Saving a PNR (ER/ET) and **ticketing** it are two different things in a real GDS, exactly like here: the "ticketing arrangement" you added in step 11 just sets a deadline (or "ticket at will"), it doesn't issue anything. TKTT is the actual ticketing entry — it requires the PNR to already be saved (has a record locator) and to have a fare quote, ticketing arrangement, and form of payment on file, and it generates a real-format ticket number (airline numeric code + serial) per passenger, including infants.

If you change the itinerary after ticketing (sell or cancel a segment), the ticket(s) are automatically voided along with the fare quote — you'll need to WP and TKTT again before saving.

15

Print or save the customer a copy of the itinerary/invoice (optional)

EMI

EMI ends the transaction (same requirements as ER/ET) and generates a formatted itinerary/invoice document — passenger names, flights, seats, the fare breakdown, form of payment, and ticket numbers if TKTT has already run. In the browser edition this opens in a new tab you can print or "Save as PDF" from your browser's print dialog; the CLI edition prints the same content directly in the terminal. Two related entries generate narrower documents the same way: EM (itinerary only, no fare/payment) and EMT (ticket-focused, notes "NOT YET TICKETED" if you haven't run TKTT yet). All three clear the work area on success, like ET.

16

Look up the booking again later

*ABC123

(using the actual locator you were given)

To see the full chronological history of everything that's been added, changed, or cancelled on the PNR:

*H

17

Queue the PNR for follow-up (optional)

Format: QE + queue number (once the PNR has been saved with ER/ET)

QE25

Places the saved PNR on queue **25** for later work — real agencies route PNRs to numbered queues for things like ticketing follow-up or schedule changes, rather than an agent handling everything in one sitting. Queuing clears the work area, the same as ET.

To see how many PNRs are waiting on each queue:

QC

Or check one specific queue:

QC25

To pull the next PNR off a queue and load it into the work area:

QN25

This works one PNR at a time, first-in-first-out — exactly how an agent works a real queue. An empty or unused queue number just reports there's nothing there.

Quick reference

STEP	COMMAND	EXAMPLE
Sign in	SI	SI
Search flights	A{DD}{MON}{ORIG}{DEST}	A15AUGDFWORD
Sell from list	0{LINE}{CLASS}{SEATS}	04Y1
Long/direct sell	0{AL}{FLT}{CLASS}{DD}{MON}{ORIG}{DEST}{STATUS}{SEATS}	0AA100Y15AUGDFWORDNN1
Add name	–{SURNAME}/{GIVEN} {TITLE}	–SMITH/JOHN MR
Add multiple passengers	–{N}{SURNAME}/{G1} {T1}/{G2} {T2}	–2SMITH/JOHN MR/JANE MRS
Add lap infant	–... (INF{SURNAME}/{GIVEN}/{DOB})	–SMITH/JOHN MR (INFSMITH/BABY/12JAN26)
Add travel document (APIS)	3DOCS{TYPE}/{CTY}/{NUM}/{NATL}/{DOB}/{SEX}/{EXP}–{PAX#}[.{INFANT#}]	3D0CSP/US/123456789/US/12JAN90/M/25DEC30–1 or ...–1.1
Add SSR	3{SSRCODE}[–{PAX#}][/{TEXT}]	3VGML
Add OSI	30SI{AL}{TEXT}	30SIAA VIP PASSENGER
Add frequent flyer number (+ tier)	3FQTV{AL}{NUMBER}[/{TIER}]	3FQTVAA1234567/GLD
Add general remark	5{TEXT}	5VIP CLIENT
Seat map / assign seat	4{N} / 4{N}–{SEAT}	41 / 41–14A
Decode airport code	DC{CODE}	DCORD
Search airports by name	DAN{TEXT}	DANCHICAGO
Price itinerary (+ corporate code)	WP[/{CORPCODE}]	WP or WP/ACME01

STEP	COMMAND	EXAMPLE
Add phone	9{NUMBER}-{LOC}	9214555-1234-A
Add received-from	6{TEXT}	6JSMITH
Add ticketing	7TAW/	7TAW/
Add form of payment	FPCASH, FPCHECK, FPCC{TYPE}-{NUM}/{MMYY}	FPCASH
Save booking	ER or ET	ER
Issue ticket	TKTT	TKTT
Print/save itinerary, invoice, or e-ticket document	EM, EMI, EMT	EMI
Redisplay PNR	*R or *	*R
Show PNR activity history	*H	*H
Retrieve saved PNR	*{LOCATOR}	*ABC123
Place PNR on a queue	QE{N}	QE25
Show queue counts	QC or QC{N}	QC or QC25
Retrieve next PNR from a queue	QN{N}	QN25
Cancel an item	X{N}, X{N}-{M}, X{N},{M}	X2
Cancel entire itinerary	XI	XI
Discard unsaved work	IG	IG
Full command list	HELP	HELP

Full walkthrough, start to finish

```
SI
A15AUGDFWORD
04Y1
-SMITH/JOHN MR
3D0CSP/US/123456789/US/12JAN90/M/25DEC30-1
3VGML
41-14A
WP
9214555-1234-A
6JSMITH
7TAW/
FPCASH
ER
TKTT
```

Command & terminology keymap, by PNR stage

Every command and every piece of jargon from this guide, grouped by where it fits in building a PNR from scratch.

STAGE 01

Sign on

COMMAND	DOES
SI	Sign in
SI{sine}/{pcc}	Sign in with a specific agent sine and pseudo city code
SO	Sign out
HELP	Full in-app command reference

TERMINOLOGY

Sine — the agent's identifying code, shown on every sign-in and stamped on the PNR's activity log

PCC — (Pseudo City Code) the agency/office identifier an agent is signed in under

GDS — (Global Distribution System) the reservation platform itself; PNRs, fares, and inventory all live in it

STAGE 02

Shop for availability

COMMAND	DOES
A{DD}{MON}{ORG}{DST}	Air availability
1{DD}{MON}{ORG}{DST}	Air availability (alternate entry, same result)
DC{CODE}	Decode a 3-letter airport/city code
DAN{TEXT}	Search airports/cities by name

TERMINOLOGY

Availability display — the numbered list of flights returned by an A/1 entry

Line number — the number to the left of each flight on the availability display, used to sell it

Class of service — the single-letter fare class (F First, J/C Business, Y/B/M Economy) shown with a seat count per flight

EQP — the aircraft equipment code (e.g. 738, 320) shown on each flight line

STAGE 03

Sell the itinerary

COMMAND	DOES
0{LINE}{CLASS}{SEATS}	Sell from an availability line
0{AL}{FLT}{CLASS}{DD}{MON}{ORG}{DST}{STATUS}{SEATS}	Long/direct sell (no availability display needed)
X{N}	Cancel element N
X{N}-{M}, X{N},{M}	Cancel a range or list of elements
XI	Cancel the entire itinerary (all segments)

TERMINOLOGY

Segment — one sold flight on the PNR

Long sell — selling a specific flight directly by airline/flight number, bypassing the availability display

Status code — the two-letter segment status: HK = holds confirmed; HL = waitlisted (a class sold down to 0 remaining sells as a waitlist request instead of being blocked); NN = need/request, used when typing a long-sell entry by hand

Party size — the number of seats requested in a sell entry; caps how many passenger names the PNR can carry

PNR element — any single numbered line on the PNR display (a name, a segment, a phone, etc.) — what X{N} cancels

STAGE 04

Add passenger data (name field & documents)

COMMAND	DOES
—{SURNAME}/{GIVEN} {TITLE}	Add a name
—{N}{SURNAME}/{G1} {T1}/{G2} {T2}	Add multiple passengers sharing a surname in one entry
—... (INF{SURNAME}/{GIVEN}/{DOB})	Attach a lap infant to the name just added
3DOCS{TYPE}/{CTY}/{NUM}/{NATL}/{DOB}/{SEX}/{EXP}—{PAX#} [. {INFANT#}]	Add a travel document (APIS) for a passenger, or for their infant

TERMINOLOGY

Name field — the passenger name(s) on the PNR; required before pricing

Lap infant — an infant traveling on an adult's lap rather than in their own seat; doesn't count against the party size/seats-sold limit

DOB format — DDMONY, e.g. 12JAN26

APIS — (Advance Passenger Information) passport/nationality/date-of-birth data governments require for international travel, tied to a specific passenger by number — or, for an infant, by {PAX#}.{INFANT#} (Sabre-style decimal notation, since an infant has no name-field entry of its own)

STAGE 05

Special service requests / other service info

COMMAND	DOES
3{SSRCODE}[-{PAX#}][/{TEXT}]	Add a special service request
30SI{AL}{TEXT}	Add other-service-info free text to a carrier
3FQTV{AL}{NUMBER}[/{TIER}]	Add a frequent flyer number, optionally with a loyalty tier
5{TEXT}	Add a general remark (agency-internal, not sent to the carrier)

TERMINOLOGY

SSR — (Special Service Request) a coded request to the airline: meals, wheelchair assistance, unaccompanied minor, extra baggage, etc.

OSI — (Other Service Info) free-text information sent to a carrier that isn't a coded SSR

FQTV — frequent flyer number, stored as a special kind of SSR; can carry a loyalty tier (SLV/GLD/PLT/DIA)

General remark — an agency-internal note on the PNR, distinct from OSI (which the carrier sees)

STAGE 06

Seat selection

COMMAND	DOES
4{N}	Display the seat map for segment N
4{N}-{SEAT}	Assign a seat on segment N

TERMINOLOGY

Seat map — the row/column grid of open (.) and occupied (X) seats for a segment

STAGE 07

Price the itinerary

COMMAND	DOES
WP	Price the itinerary
WPNCs	Price at the lowest fare, regardless of seat availability (informational only)
WP/{CORPCODE}, WPNCs/{CORPCODE}	Price using a negotiated/corporate fare code

TERMINOLOGY

Fare quote — the stored pricing result on the PNR; required before ticketing, and cleared automatically if the itinerary changes afterward

Fare basis — the short code summarizing the fare's class and trip type (e.g. YOW = Y class, one-way)

Base fare — the pre-tax fare amount

Taxes/fees — the itemized government and carrier charges added on top of the base fare

Fare rules — the change fee, refundability, and advance-purchase requirement shown with every fare quote, keyed off the itinerary's class

Corporate/negotiated fare code — an account code that unlocks a discounted fare tier

STAGE 08 Add contact & booking info

COMMAND	DOES
9{NUMBER}-{LOC}	Add a phone number
9/{CTY}{NUMBER}-{LOC}	Add a phone number, out-of-area (with city code)
6{TEXT}	Add "received from"

TERMINOLOGY

Phone field — the contact number(s) on the PNR; required before end transaction

Location code — the phone type suffix (A=Agency, H=Home, B=Business, C/M=Cell, F=Fax, HTL=Hotel)

Received From (RF) — who requested the booking; required before end transaction, same as a phone field

STAGE 09 Ticketing arrangement & form of payment

COMMAND	DOES
7TAW/	Ticketing at will (no deadline)
7TAW{DD}{MON}/{HHMM}	Ticketing at will, queued to a date/time
7TAX{DD}{MON}/{HHMM}	Ticketing time limit
FPCASH	Form of payment: cash
FPCHECK	Form of payment: check
FPCC{TYPE}{CARDNUM}/{MMYY}	Form of payment: credit card

TERMINOLOGY

Ticketing arrangement — the deadline (or lack of one) by which the PNR must be ticketed; not the same as ticketing itself

Ticket at will — no fixed ticketing deadline

Time limit — a fixed date/time by which the PNR must be ticketed or it's expected to cancel

Form of payment (FOP) — how the ticket will be paid for; required before end transaction. Card numbers are masked to the last 4 digits once stored

STAGE 10 End transaction

COMMAND	DOES
ER	End transaction, redisplay the saved PNR
ET	End transaction, clear the work area for a new booking
IG	Ignore the PNR (discard unsaved work)

TERMINOLOGY

RLOC — (Record Locator) the 6-character confirmation code assigned the first time a PNR is end-transacted

End transaction — saving the PNR; requires a segment, a name, a fare quote, a phone, a received-from, a form of payment, and a ticketing arrangement all on file

STAGE 11

Ticket issuance

COMMAND

DOES

TKTT

Issue ticket number(s)

TERMINOLOGY

Validating carrier — the airline whose numeric code prefixes the issued ticket number(s); taken from the first segment

Ticketing vs. ticketing arrangement — the arrangement (7TAW/7TAX) only sets a deadline; TKTT is the entry that actually issues ticket numbers, and requires the PNR to already be saved (has an RLOC)

STAGE 12

Documents

COMMAND

DOES

EM

End transaction, generate an itinerary document (no fare/payment)

EMI

End transaction, generate an invoice document (adds fare summary, form of payment, ticket numbers if issued)

EMT

End transaction, generate an e-ticket notification document

TERMINOLOGY

Itinerary/invoice document — a customer-facing formatted document (browser: printable page/PDF in a new tab; CLI: formatted terminal block), distinct from the PNR display an agent sees - EM/EMI/EMT are end-transaction entries like ER/ET, requiring the same completeness, and clear the work area on success

STAGE 13

Retrieve & review

COMMAND

DOES

*R or *

Redisplay the current PNR

*H

Show the PNR's chronological activity history

*{LOCATOR}

Retrieve a saved PNR by its record locator

TERMINOLOGY

Activity log / PNR history — the timestamped, sine-stamped record of every action taken on a PNR, viewed with *H, separate from the record-locator lookup done with *{LOCATOR}

COMMAND	DOES
QE{N}	Place the saved PNR on queue N; clears the work area
QC	Show a count of PNRs on every non-empty queue
QC{N}	Show the count of PNRs on queue N specifically
QN{N}	Retrieve the next (first-in) PNR off queue N into the work area

TERMINOLOGY

Queue — a numbered bucket of PNRs awaiting follow-up work (schedule change, ticketing, general review); the backbone of real-world agent workflow, distinct from *{LOCATOR} retrieval which requires already knowing the exact record locator

Queue count — how many PNRs are currently sitting on a given queue, shown by QC

Working a queue — repeatedly entering QN{N} to pull PNRs off a queue one at a time, in the order they were placed there